Please see below questions in response to the RFI posted for the F5 Load Balancer Replacement and Maintenance Support 36C10B27Q0089 VA-27-00017931

Quantities and scope

1. The PWS describes the current environment as one standalone and two HA pair i5820-DF platforms, which we read as 5 units, but CLIN 1 requests 3 r5920-DF units. Please confirm the current and replacement unit counts at AEDC and PEDC.

2 at AECD and 1 at PEDC

2. For the 1:1 migration, how many virtual servers, pools, iRules, APM policies and tenants are in scope, how many APM users are supported, and what peak throughput is required?

361 virtual, 699 pool members, 63 iRules, 12 apm policy , 1 tenant , 900 apm users

Execution, testing and cutover

3. Will configuration and migration work be performed remotely or at the AEDC and PEDC facilities? PWS 4.2 states remote performance, while Addendum A4 addresses on-site presence and PWS 5.0 describes maintenance windows at the data centers. If remote, how will the contractor connect (for example Government-furnished equipment, VPN or virtual desktop), and who on the VA side performs physical actions during each window?

Support is all remote; FSC network team would perform all things onsite.

4. Who performs rack, cabling and optics installation (14 SFP28), and what are the delivery addresses and points of contact for PWS 6.3?

AEDC and PEDC cabling team together with FSC network team.

5. How will validation and testing be done before cutover? Is a lab or staging environment available, will configurations be validated in parallel with production, who defines the acceptance criteria and sign-off, and what are the rollback criteria?

There is no testing environment, no validation in parallel, site would determine acceptance, sign off and rollback criteria.

6. Will cutover occur on a single date per site or in phases over multiple days? PWS 5.0 anticipates about four after-hours windows at AEDC and about four business hours at PEDC. What is the duration of each AEDC window, are the windows consecutive or spread over time, and in what order are the sites and platforms (standalone and HA pairs) to be migrated?

PEDC (standalone) is not an online device and can be done on a single date, during working hours. AEDC cutover must occur on a single date after 6.00pm; duration is until the server is back online and working, schedule to be four hours.

Labor, schedule and pricing

7. Do the 80 hours of Standard consulting (CLIN 10) and 8 hours of Premium consulting (CLIN 11) represent the Government's total labor estimate? Are discovery, configuration review, staging and testing, and post-cutover support included in those hours or to be priced separately? May a qualified firm other than F5 perform this work?

The 80/8 labor hours and consulting was estimated for replacement by brand-name F5 only. Anything other than replacement by F5, please provide estimated hours for each task.

8. RFI question 5 asks for yearly license subscription costs, while the PWS lists perpetual licenses plus Premium support. Which structure should the ROM follow? I don't see PWS containing "perpetual licenses" language.

9. What are the anticipated RFQ release and award dates, and is a questions cutoff or a Q&A release planned? No Q&A release is planned. Quotes are welcome with the RFI response. Award will be on or around October 1, 2027.

Acquisition strategy

10. What are the anticipated evaluation factors and their relative weights (price, technical, past performance), and will an OEM authorization letter be a pass/fail requirement? Will be determined after market research is completed.

11. Do you know which contract vehicle the RFQ will use? The PWS lists SEWP V CLINs. Must offerors hold that vehicle? Contract vehicle will be determined after market research is completed.

12. The PWS cites SEWP V CLINs. Will award be made under NASA SEWP (which version) or another vehicle, and must offerors hold that vehicle? Contract vehicle will be determined after market research is completed.

13. The PWS restricts competition to F5 and its authorized distributors. May a firm that is not an F5 authorized reseller participate as a subcontractor to an authorized reseller for migration planning, project management and post-migration support? Once the

requirement is finalized and an RFQ is released vendors will be notified if they must be an F5 reseller to participate.

14. The draft includes template language (for example PWS 6.1.5 .msi packaging, 6.1.8 and 6.1.9 identity items, EPEAT/Energy Star, BAA, and deliverables referencing tasks 5.1.1, 6.2.2 and 6.7). Which of these remain applicable? None – will be removed from PWS

Security and onboarding

15. What personnel risk level and background investigation apply, and are A&A, FedRAMP, PHI or a BAA, or access to sensitive personal information expected? None required.

Response format

16. Is a one-page company capability statement acceptable, or does it count as marketing material? Does the identification page count toward the 25-page limit? A one-page company capability statement is acceptable; it does not count towards the 25-page limit.